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iges file format

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AI Overview

The **IGES** (Initial Graphics Exchange Specification) file format—commonly using `.iges` or `.igs` extensions—is a vendor-neutral, ASCII-based textual standard used to transfer 2D and 3D computer-aided design (CAD) data between different software systems. Learn more about the specification on the Wikipedia IGES Page.

Key Characteristics

- **File Structure:** Built on ASCII text with fixed 80-character lines divided into five main sections: Start (S), Global (G), Directory Entry (D), Parameter Data (P), and Terminate (T). Wikipedia +1
- **Geometry Types:** Represents wireframes, surface models, and boundary representation (B-rep) entities using mathematical definitions like NURBS (Non-Uniform Rational B-Splines). Adobe +2
- **History:** Developed in the late 1970s via the US Air Force ICAM project, published in 1980, and finalized with Version 5.3 in 1996. CAD Exchanger +1
- **Compatibility:** Widely supported across legacy and modern CAD applications (such as AutoCAD, SolidWorks, and Fusion 360) as well as text editors. Spatial Corp +2

Pros and Cons

- **Pros:**
  - High level of cross-platform and legacy system support.
  - Preserves surface and curve geometry accurately compared to mesh formats like STL. All3DP +2
- **Cons:**
  - Outdated standardization (un-updated since 1996).
  - Lacks support for modern features like Product and Manufacturing Information (PMI), material properties, or solid body parametric histories.
  - Frequently replaced today by the more capable STEP (`.step` / `.stp`) format. Adobe +4

Are you trying to **open, convert, or export an IGES file** in a specific CAD program, and what software are you using?

Ask anything

Wikipedia
IGES - Wikipedia
Overview: The Initial Graphics Exchange Specification (IGES) is a vendor-neutral,...



Eclipsepedia
IGES file Specification
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IGES

The Initial Graphics Exchange Specification (IGES) is a **vendor-neutral file format** that allows the digital exchange of information among computer-aided ... Read more

History | File format | Foreign-language support | A recursive standard

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IGES

IGES is both a 2D and 3D format. IGES.pdf. Example. A simple example IGES file (so you may recognise one when you see it) is shown below. Each line is based ... Read more

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File Formats: IGES File

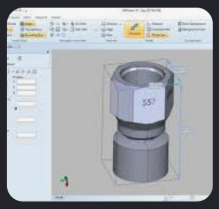
IGES (Initial Graphics Exchange Specification) is an ANSI standard. Geometry is defined mathematically using analytic and parametric surfaces and curves, such ... Read more

CAD Exchanger
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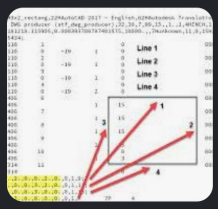
IGES file format and extensions

The **IGES format** was developed to provide a universal standard for exchanging 3D data between different CAD software applications. IGES files, represented in ... Read more

Images



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TechSoft3D
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IGES Reader — HOOPS Exchange Documentation

IGES (Initial Graphics Exchange Specification) is a **neutral CAD file format** used to exchange 2D and 3D design data such as curves, surfaces, and wireframe ... Read more

University of South Carolina
https://people.math.sc.edu › Burkardt › data › iges › iges

IGES Files

IGES is a data directory which contains examples of IGES files. IGES File Characteristics: **ASCII**. Licensing: The computer code and data files described ... Read more

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